Tradelink Technical Specification

Field	Value
Document	Technical Specification Document (TSD), as built
Product	Tradelink, with Tradelink AI
Version	1.1
Date	4 November 2026
Status	Draft for review
Owner	Janya Mali
Code baseline	`develop` at commit `9250e98` and 17 applied database migrations (latest `20261104040939`)

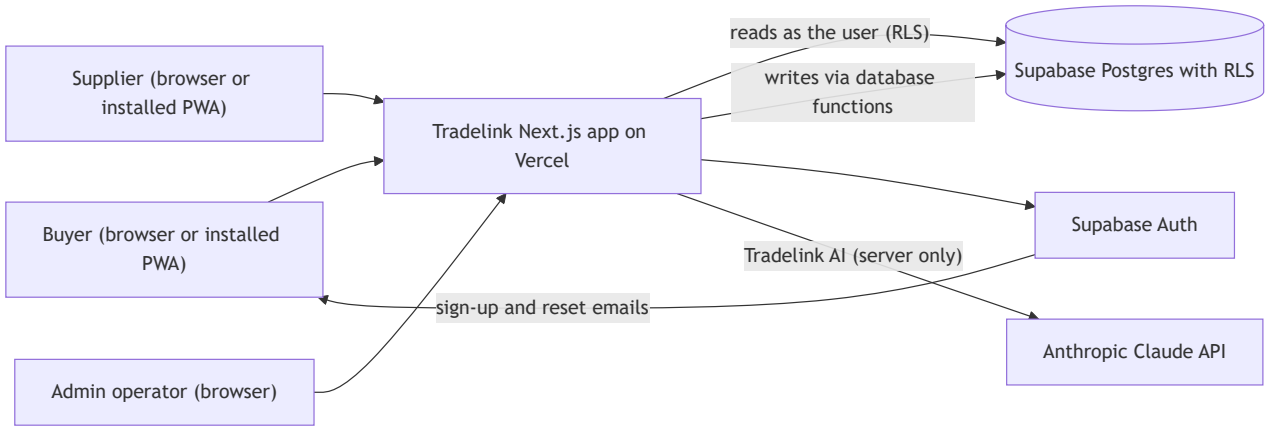
Contents

1. Overview
2. Technology choices
3. Considered but not used
4. Architecture
5. Key flows
6. Data model
7. Security
8. Testing
9. Delivery and operations
10. Running cost

Purpose. How Tradelink is built, what it uses and why, and what was left out and why. For engineers maintaining the code. Requirements are in the Functional Specification. Where a reason was not recorded, it is marked **Inferred rationale**.

---

1. Overview



- The browser never talks to Supabase or Claude directly; every read and write runs on the server as the signed-in user.
- One responsive app serves phone and laptop (layout switches at 760 px) and installs as a PWA.
- Layout: `app/<role>/` routes, `src/features/` actions and queries, `src/domain/` pure rules, `src/data/` Supabase clients, `src/integrations/claude/` AI client, `src/ui/` components.

2. Technology choices

Versions are from `package.json`.

Technology	Version	Why it is used
Next.js (App Router)	16.4.2	Server components and server actions keep keys, data access and AI on the server; one codebase for phone and laptop; Vercel deploys it natively (ADR 0002)
React	19.3.1	Comes with Next.js; `useActionState` and transitions handle form saves
TypeScript (strict)	6.0.3	Catches errors at build time; `any` is banned by lint
Tailwind CSS, with design tokens	4.3.3	Utility classes generated from the design system's `tokens.json`; one token file drives light and dark mode (ADR 0015)
Supabase: Postgres, Auth, RLS	supabase-js 2.118.0, ssr 0.12.7	Real transactions and row locks for stock; Row Level Security for tenancy; managed sign-in and password reset (ADR 0003)
`security definer` database functions	—	Every write checks role, state, stock, audit and notification in one transaction; there are no write policies (ADR 0004)
Claude Sonnet 5.5 via `@anthropic-ai/sdk`	0.135.0, model `claude-sonnet-5-5`	Tradelink AI: tool use for reading and proposing actions, streaming replies, prompt caching (ADR 0008)
Zod	4.6.7	One schema validates action input, route bodies and AI tool input
Vitest	4.1.12	Fast unit tests for pure domain rules and feature logic

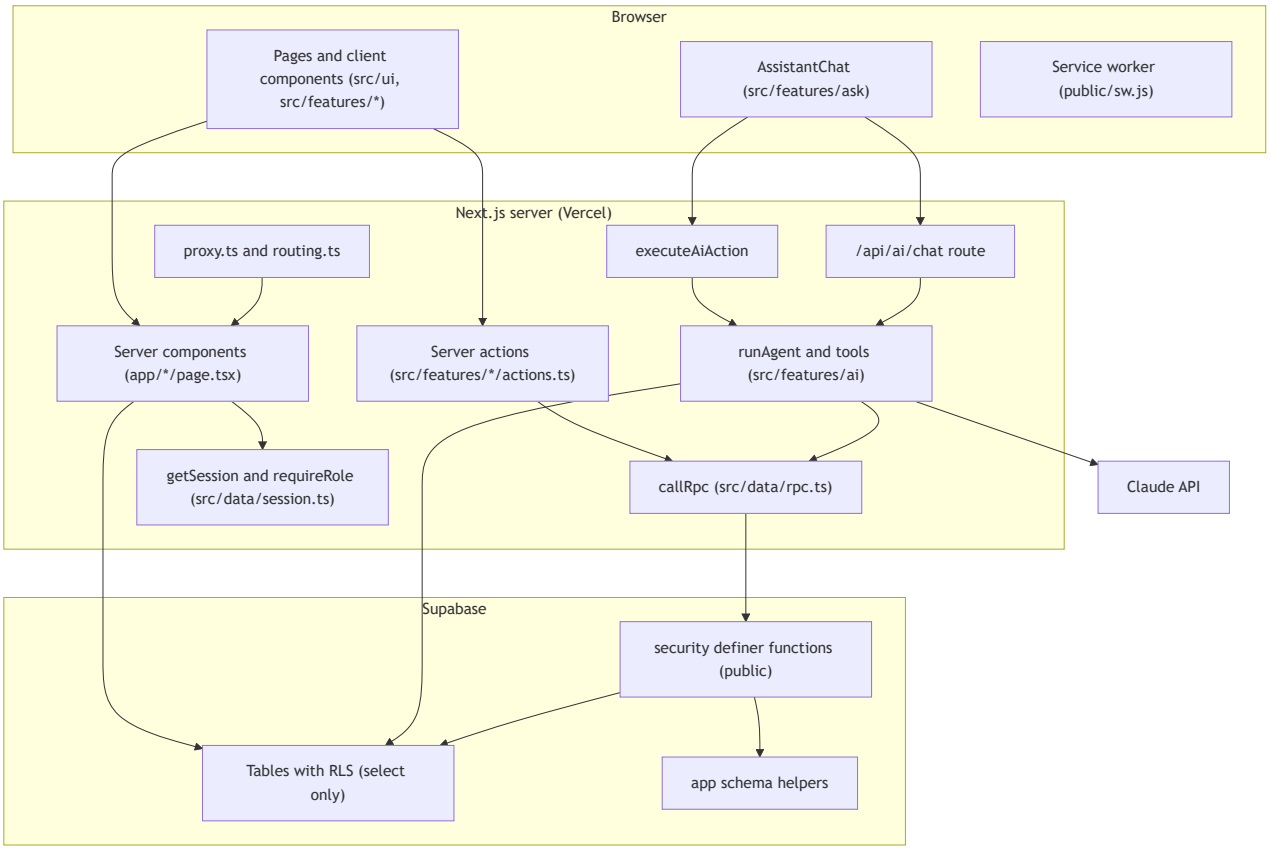
Technology	Version	Why it is used
Playwright	1.56.1	End-to-end tests on desktop Chrome and a Pixel 7 profile; also captures documentation screenshots
Vercel	Hobby plan	Git-connected deploys: `develop` previews, `main` production
`web-push`	3.6.7	Installed for push notifications; not switched on (section 3)

Rules that follow: reads use the user's session, so RLS decides visibility; writes go only through database functions (`callRpc`), with an idempotency key on critical ones; money is integer cents in TypeScript and `numeric(12,2)` in Postgres, times in Asia/Singapore (ADR 0019); the AI never writes without a person's tap.

3. Considered but not used

Option	Status	Why not (limitation or decision)
Native iOS and Android apps	Not used	One responsive PWA covers phone and laptop with one codebase; users already work in a browser or WhatsApp (ADR 0016)
Stripe or any payments	Not used	Owner decision, 4 November 2026: no payments or subscription billing
Email provider (Resend)	Not configured	No provider account or key; only Supabase Auth's own sign-up and reset emails are sent (ADR 0012 is not built)
Push notifications	Built, not switched on	Plumbing exists (`web-push`, `/api/push/*`, service worker), but no opt-in button and no sender call it; VAPID keys are not set in Vercel
Scheduled jobs (`pg_cron`)	Not applied	The runner and `supabase/migrations/pending_ai_job_cron.sql` exist; the schedule waits for the server secret key in Vercel. Nothing in the live app needs jobs
Supabase branching for a test database	Not available	Needs the Supabase Pro plan; the attempt failed on the Free plan, so tests that write were not run
CI (GitHub Actions)	None	Checks run locally with `npm run check` before pushing. Inferred rationale: a one-developer sprint
Coverage tooling	None	No coverage package is installed; coverage is not measured
Content Security Policy	None	Other headers are set in `next.config.ts`; a CSP was planned in ADR 0010 but not added
Two-factor sign-in	Removed	Owner decision for a working demo with self sign-up (ADR 0024)
Invoice upload and checks (OCR)	Not built	Out of the sprint scope; only an unused `invoice` problem type remains
Rules-based order reader in the live path	Not used	`readOrderWithClaude` with grounding and a rules fallback exists but has no UI caller; the live assistant uses tools instead
AI evaluation set	None	No `evals/` folder; AI behaviour is covered by unit tests with a mocked SDK

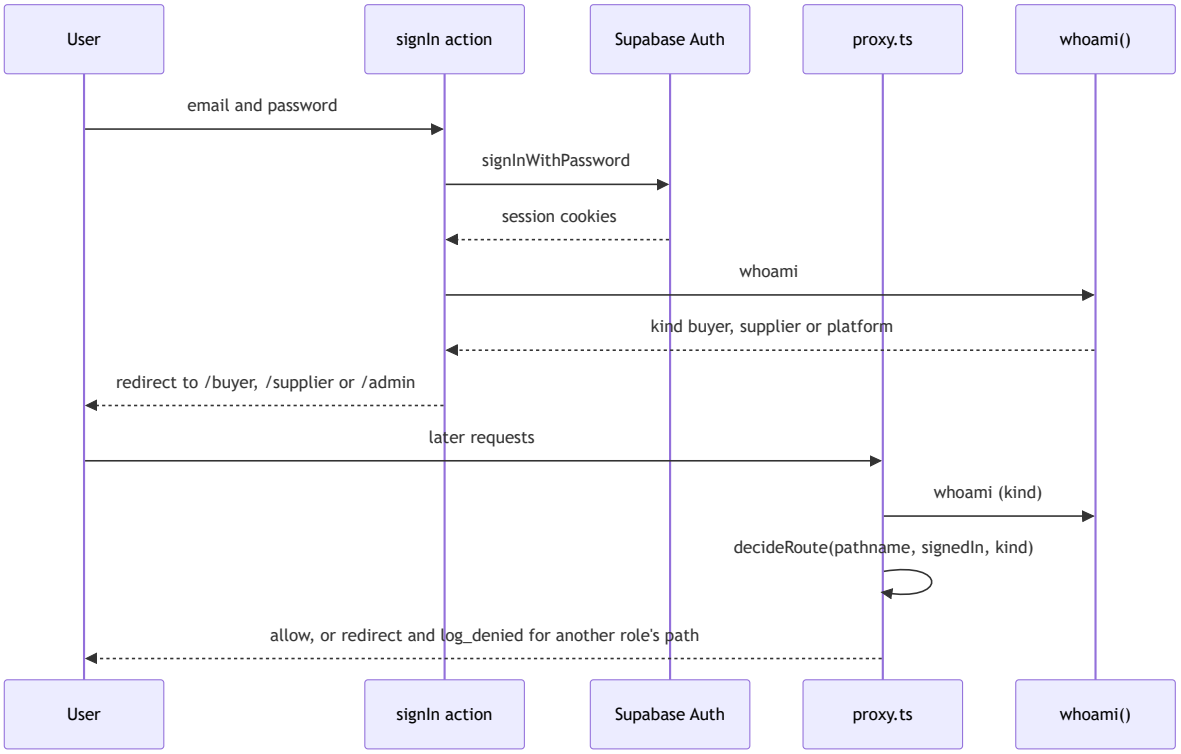
4. Architecture



- **Server and client.** Server modules import `server-only`, so a client import fails the build; client components hold no keys.
- **Rendering.** Pages are server components that call `requireRole` and read through RLS; changes are server actions ending in `revalidatePath`.
- **Dependencies.** `app/` → `src/features/` → `src/data/`, `src/domain/`, `src/ui/`; `src/domain/` imports nothing, so its rules are tested without a database.
- **Errors.** Database functions raise `TLnnn:REASON:detail`; `callRpc` maps the reason to fixed copy (`src/lib/errors.ts`) and logs blocked attempts.
- **Logging.** `src/lib/logger.ts` writes JSON lines to Vercel logs and redacts sensitive field names.

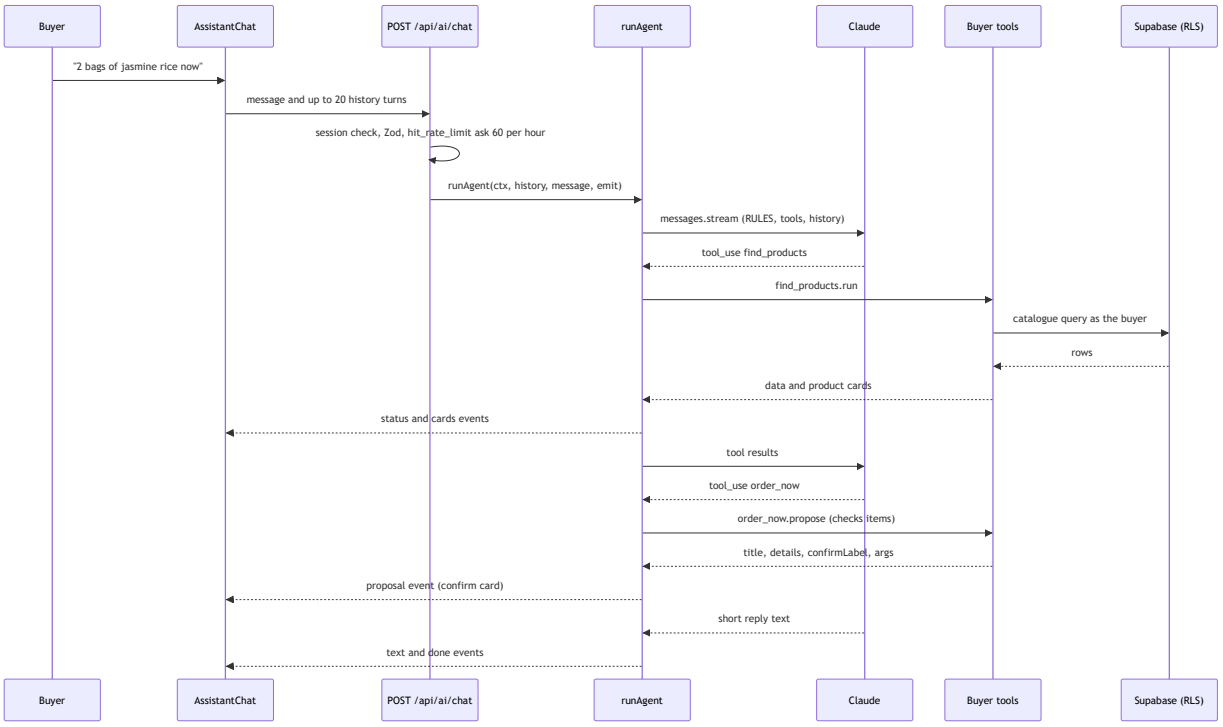
5. Key flows

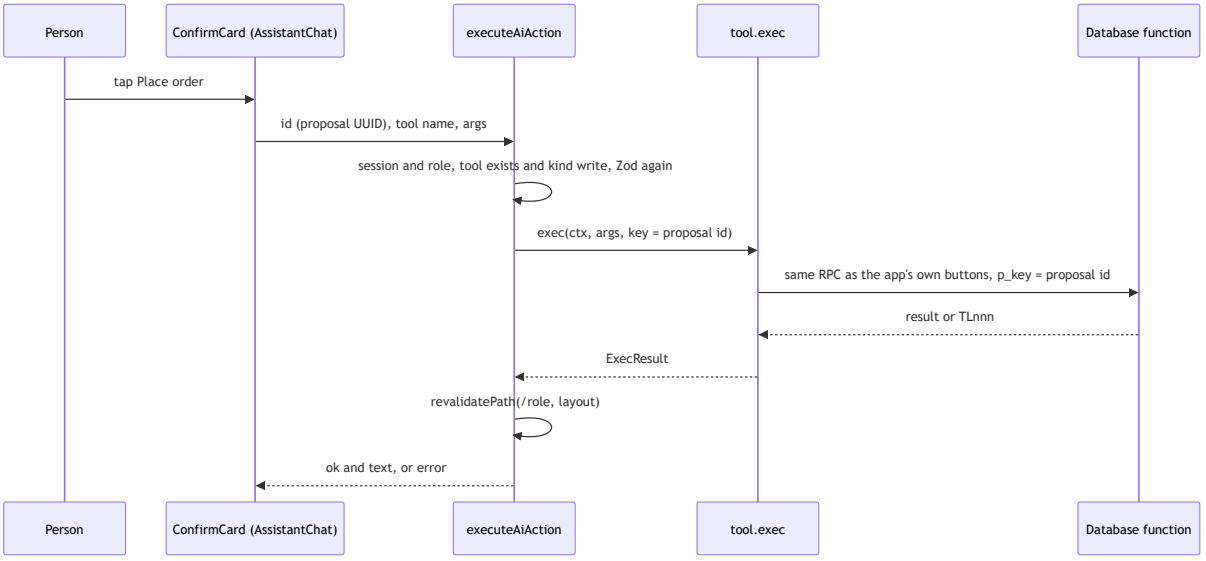
5.1 Sign-in and roles



The organisation's `kind` is the role and also drives RLS. The proxy only redirects; the database enforces every permission. Self sign-up runs `app.handle_new_user`, which creates the organisation and connects it to every active counterpart.

5.2 Tradelink AI with confirm cards

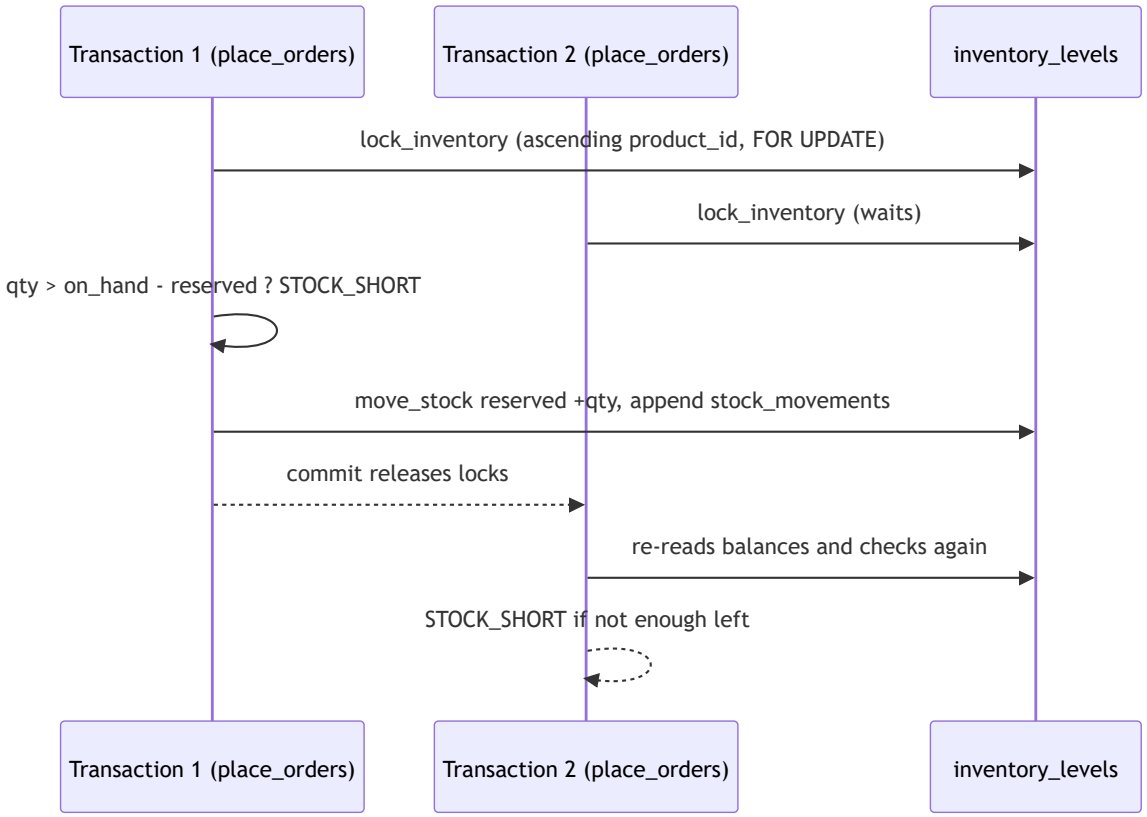




- **Why.** The model only reads and proposes. A change runs after a person taps, is validated again on the server and uses the same database functions as the app's buttons; the proposal id is the idempotency key.
- **Limits.** 2,000 characters per message, 20 history turns, 60 messages per hour, 6 tool rounds; prompt caching on rules, tools and conversation.
- **Tools.** Buyers: 11 read, 17 confirm, 2 card-only. Suppliers: 7 read, 17 confirm, 1 card-only (`buyer-tools.ts`, `supplier-tools.ts`).
- **Safety.** Tool results are data, tools run as the user under RLS, and writes need a tap (ADR 0010). Without a key the route returns 503.

5.3 Placing orders and reserving stock

`place_orders` locks inventory, checks availability, creates one order per supplier, reserves stock and writes events, audit and notifications in one transaction.

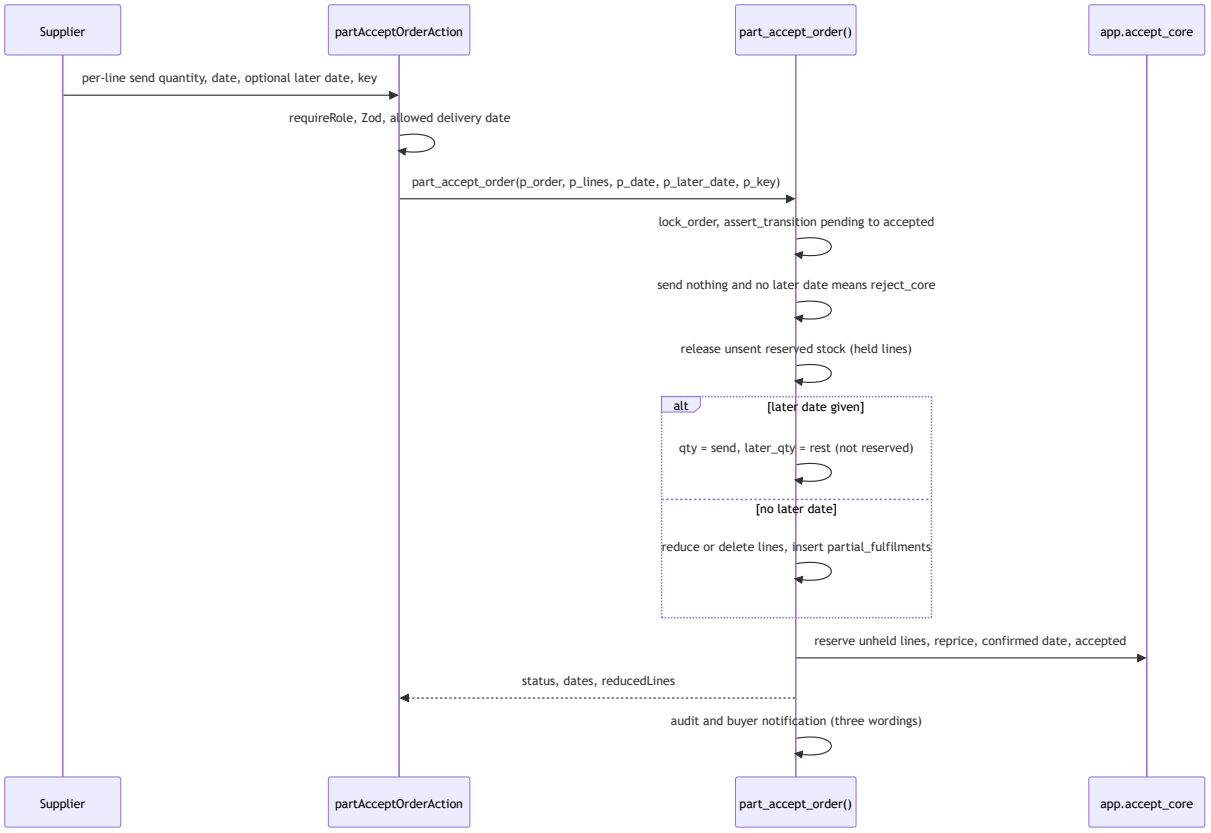


`supabase/migrations/20261103085139_app_functions.sql`

```
create function app.lock_inventory(p_products uuid[]) returns void
language plpgsql set search_path = '' as $$
begin
  perform 1 from public.inventory_levels i
  where i.product_id = any (p_products)
  order by i.product_id
  for update;
end $$;
```

Why. Checking and reserving under row locks in one transaction is the simplest way to prevent overselling (ADR 0006); a fixed lock order avoids deadlocks, and `reserved <= on_hand` is a backstop constraint.

5.4 Part acceptance and delivery

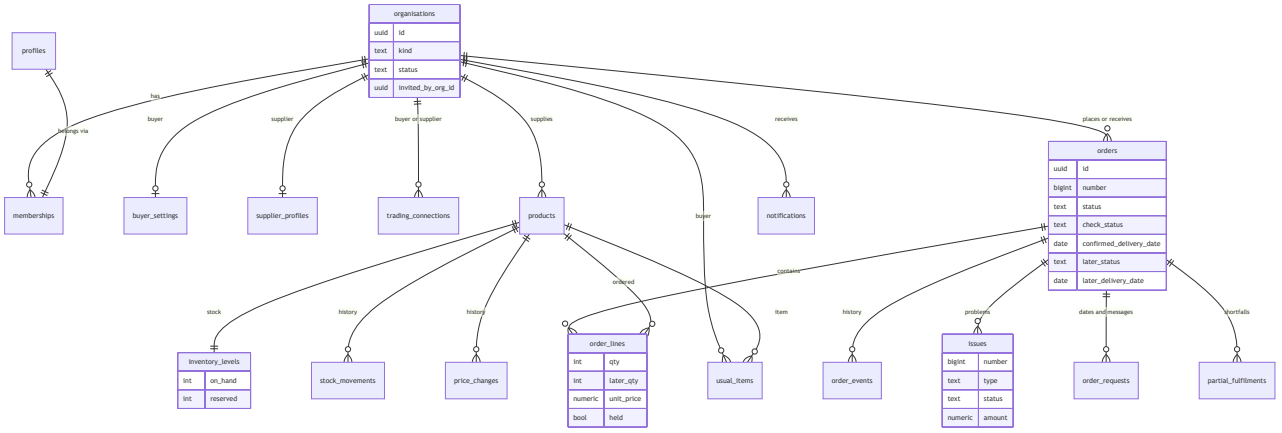


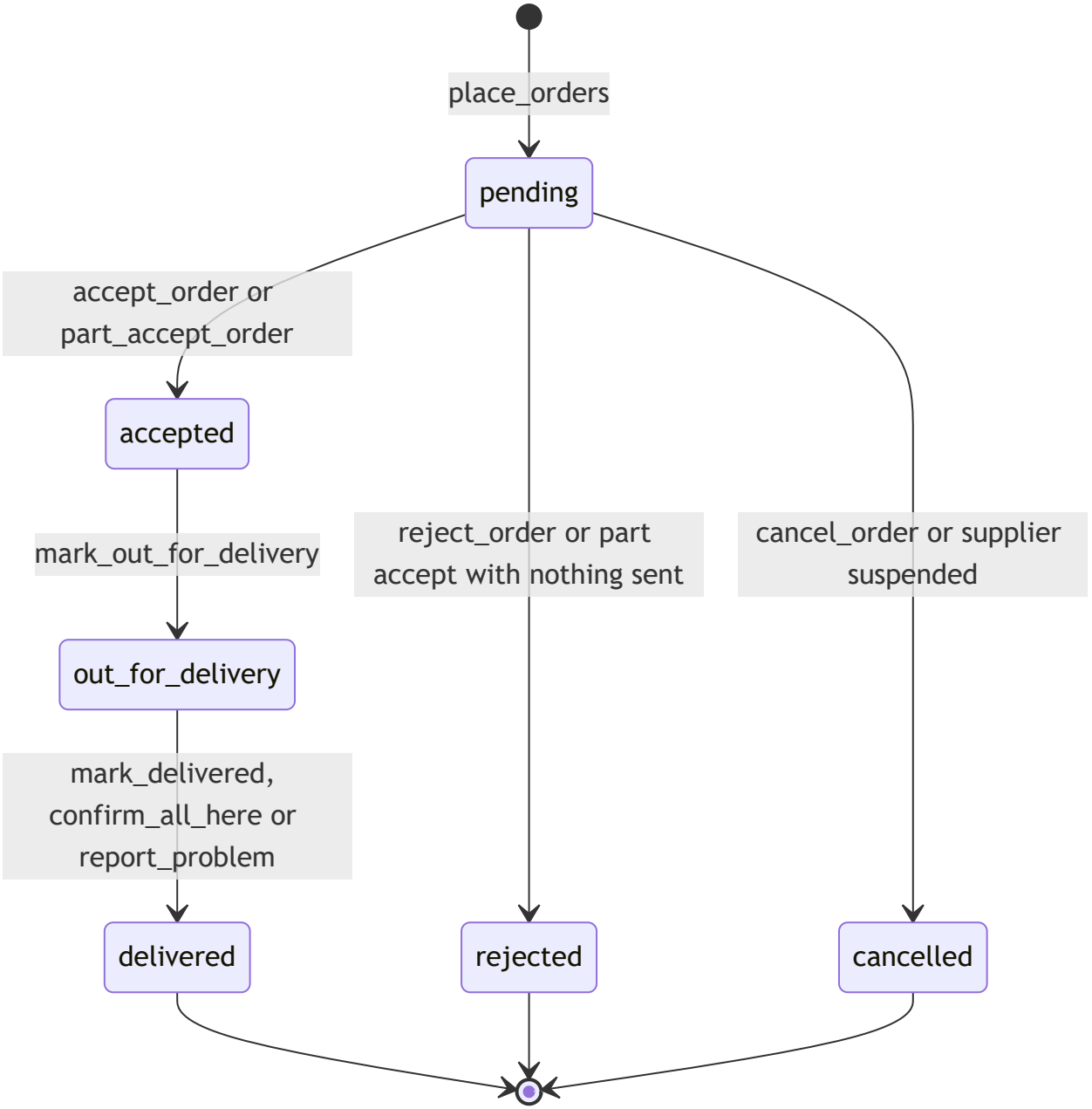
The rest of a part-accepted order is not reserved (Inferred rationale: the stock is not there yet); `deliver_rest` checks free stock when it goes.

5.5 Delivery, problems, credits and disputes

- `mark_out_for_delivery`, then `mark_delivered`, which removes the quantity from `on_hand` and `reserved`.
- The buyer confirms (`confirm_all_here`) or reports a problem (`report_problem`, amount = quantity × unit price).
- The supplier answers (`answer_issue`): credit, replace, on the way or dispute; disputes are settled by an admin (`resolve_dispute`). A credit closes when the buyer confirms it (`mark_credit_received`).
- Notifications are in-app rows written in the same transaction as the change.

6. Data model


profiles
has
belongs via
organisations
uuid id
text kind
text status
uuid invited_by_org_id
memberships
buyer
buyer_settings
supplier
supplier_profiles
buyer or supplier
trading_connections
supplies
products
receives
notifications
places or receives
orders
uuid id
bigint number
text status
text check_status
date confirmed_delivery_date
text later_status
date later_delivery_date
buyer
stock
inventory_levels
int on_hand
int reserved
history
stock_movements
history
price_changes
ordered
contains
order_lines
int qty
int later_qty
numeric unit_price
bool held
item
usual_items
history
order_events
problems
issues
bigint number
text type
text status
numeric amount
dates and messages
order_requests
shortfalls
partial_fulfilments


place_orders
pending
accept_order or
part_accept_order
accepted
mark_out_for_delivery
out_for_delivery
mark_delivered,
confirm_all_here or
report_problem
delivered
reject_order or part
accept with nothing sent
rejected
cancel_order or supplier
suspended
cancelled

Rule	Enforced by
Status moves only along allowed edges (orders, issues, organisations)	`app.state_transitions` table plus the `app.guard_status` trigger; functions call `app.assert_transition` first for a friendly message (ADR 0007)
Reserved stock never exceeds stock on hand	Check constraints, plus checks under lock in `place_orders` and `accept_core`
History cannot be edited	`app.forbid_change` triggers on `audit_log`, `stock_movements`, `price_changes`, `order_events`
One open "late" problem per order	Unique index `issues_one_open_late`
Schema changes	A new file in `supabase/migrations/`, named with the applied version; applied migrations are never edited

The migrations also create about 40 `rs_*` tables for a Tradelink AI foundation (cards, jobs, push), used only by the `/r` page.

7. Security

Area	How it is handled
Authentication	Supabase Auth with cookie sessions (`@supabase/ssr`); no two-factor sign-in (ADR 0024)
Authorisation	`requireRole` on pages and actions; RLS on every table; every write function calls `app.require_kind` or `app.require_member`; the operations lead is `admin_profiles.is_lead`
Data isolation	Tenancy by organisation; another business's order raises the same `NOT_FOUND` as a missing one
Secrets	`ANTHROPIC_API_KEY`, `SUPABASE_SECRET_KEY` and `VAPID_PRIVATE_KEY` are server only, in `.env.local` (git-ignored) and Vercel; the demo password is not in the repository
Input validation	Zod in every action and route, argument checks in database functions, table constraints
Rate limits	Postgres fixed window per user: AI chat 60 per hour, order messages 30 per hour
Audit	Every write calls `app.audit`; blocked attempts are logged; the log is append-only
Headers	`X-Frame-Options: DENY`, `nosniff`, HSTS, Referrer-Policy, Permissions-Policy; no CSP
File uploads	None

Accepted risks: no two-factor sign-in; self sign-up connects a new business to every counterpart; a demo password remains in old commits (owner decision).

8. Testing

Suite	Command	Result on 4 November 2026
Unit (Vitest, 72 files)	`npm test`	**838 passed, 1 skipped** (71 files passed, 1 skipped; 33 s)

Suite	Command	Result on 4 November 2026
End to end, read only	`npx playwright test e2e/smoke.spec.ts e2e/pages.spec.ts`	**16 passed** (8 tests on desktop Chrome and on a Pixel 7 profile)
End to end, order flow	`npx playwright test e2e/order-flow.spec.ts`	Not run: writes real orders to the live database
Stock concurrency (24 parallel orders)	`RUN_DB_TESTS=1 NODE_OPTIONS=--experimental-websocket npm test -- tests/concurrency`	Not run: writes to the live database
Coverage	—	Not measured: no coverage tool
Type-check and lint	`npm run typecheck`, `npm run lint`	Clean

End-to-end tests read the demo password from `E2E_PASSWORD` in `.env.local`.

9. Delivery and operations

- **Releases.** Work on `develop`; release by fast-forwarding `main`. Run `npm run check` before pushing (no CI).
- **Vercel.** `develop` makes previews, `main` deploys production; server-only variables are marked sensitive.
- **Database.** Test a migration in a rolled-back transaction, apply it, then save it in `supabase/migrations/`; keep changes backward compatible.
- **Rollback.** Promote the previous Vercel deployment; for the database, a new migration restoring the earlier definition.
- **Monitoring.** `GET /api/health` (liveness), JSON logs in Vercel, AI tokens in `ai_usage`.

10. Running cost

Item	Today	Note
Hosting (Vercel)	Hobby plan, free	Personal and non-commercial use only; Pro is US$20 per developer seat per month
Database (Supabase)	Free plan	Pauses after 7 idle days, 500 MB database; Pro is US$25 per month per organisation
AI (Claude Sonnet 5.5)	Pay per use	US$2 per million input tokens, US$10 per million output tokens, cache reads US$0.20

Measured AI use (`public.ai_usage`, 3 to 4 November 2026): 135 Tradelink AI replies, averaging 6,551 input and 223 output tokens. That is at most about **US$0.015 per reply** (all input at the full rate; caching lowers it), or about **US$2.07** for all 135.

Hosting prices are list prices from third-party summaries; check vercel.com/pricing and supabase.com/pricing before buying.